Day 59 - Sydenham Nature Reserve, Keeling, Harrison Park

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Sydenham section · hike 75 · Harrison Park, Inglis Falls & Sydenham Nature Reserve, Owen Sound

13.7 km / 8.5 mi	~4.4 h	6.3 km new	151 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

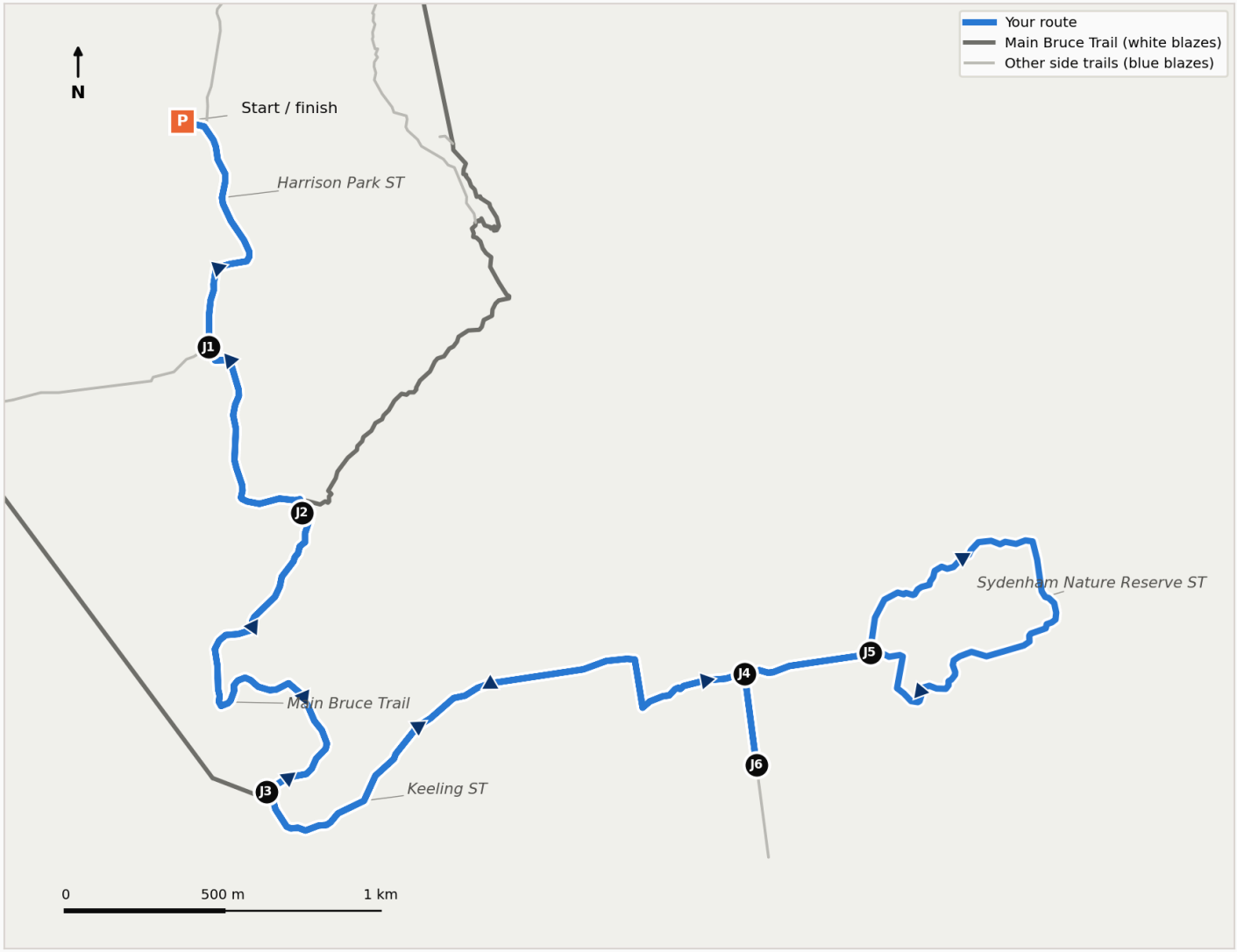
Park: Harrison Park: Excellent free parking in Harrison Park in several places. One example would be to drive east past the restaurant, over the bridge and immediately turn left into a parking area. Google Maps.

Navigate: import *day59_hike075.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Sydenham Nature Reserve Side Trail (2.4 km); Keeling Side Trail (2.3 km); Harrison Park Side Trail (1.6 km)

Route map

Day 59 | 13.7 km (8.5 mi)



What to expect

- **Parking:** Free parking in several places in Harrison Park. One option is to drive east past the restaurant, cross the bridge and turn left right away into a parking area. Owen Sound Tourism confirms that entry and parking are free.
- **Harrison Park:** More than 40 hectares of streams, gardens and forest along the Sydenham River, with wide, hard-packed trails. Weavers' Creek Falls can be seen from a boardwalk. The park's trails connect directly with the Bruce Trail toward Inglis Falls. The Harrison Park Inn restaurant is open year-round.
- **Keeling Side Trail:** Blue-blazed, natural-surface trail rated moderate. Ontario Nature Trails describes it starting near the Inglis Falls parking area, so you may pass close to the falls. It runs east to Highways 6 & 10, which you cross before a short jog south.

- **Road walking:** Two stretches of the Keeling Side Trail follow a road shoulder, and one includes the crossing of Highways 6 & 10. Keep Zappy close and on a short leash, and cross carefully.
- **Sydenham Nature Reserve Side Trail:** The Keeling trail meets the Owen Sound rail trail and joins the Sydenham Nature Reserve Side Trail, a loop through the reserve before you return the way you came. We didn't find detailed terrain notes for the reserve loop.
- **Length:** At 12.5 km this is one of the longer outings, so plan for a full morning or afternoon. Picnic areas and washrooms are listed at the Inglis Falls trailhead.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Harrison Park: Excellent free parking in Harrison Park in several places. Walk about 100 m to the trail. Head south-east on the blue-blazed Harrison Park Side Trail.
0.9	0.6	J1: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Harrison Park Side Trail, heading south-east. (the blue-blazed Creamery Hill Side Trail goes off on your right (optional extra: Creamery Hill Side Trail, 0.9 km, mostly on road, not in the plan).)
1.7	1.1	J2: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off behind you.)
3.2	2.0	J3: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Keeling Side Trail, heading south-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
4.7	2.9	Heads-up: The next 0.2 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
5.2	3.2	J4: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Sydenham Nature Reserve Side Trail, heading east. (the blue-blazed Keeling Side Trail goes off on your right.)
5.6	3.5	J5: Junction. Turn left to stay on the Sydenham Nature Reserve Side Trail, heading north. (the blue-blazed Sydenham Nature Reserve Side Trail goes off ahead.)
7.5	4.7	J5: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Sydenham Nature Reserve Side Trail, heading west. (the Sydenham Nature Reserve Side Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
8.0	4.9	J4: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Keeling Side Trail, heading south. (the Keeling Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.) The next 0.6 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
8.2	5.1	J6: Turnaround point. Turn around and retrace your steps.
8.5	5.3	J4: Junction. Turn left to stay on the Keeling Side Trail, heading west. (the Sydenham Nature Reserve Side Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
8.9	5.5	Heads-up: The next 0.2 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
10.5	6.5	J3: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
12.0	7.5	J2: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Harrison Park Side Trail, heading north. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
12.8	8.0	J1: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Harrison Park Side Trail, heading north. (the blue-blazed Creamery Hill Side Trail goes off on your left (optional extra: Creamery Hill Side Trail, 0.9 km, mostly on road, not in the plan).)
13.7	8.5	Leave the trail and walk back to the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Owen Sound Tourism, Ontario Nature Trails and the Sydenham Bruce Trail Club.